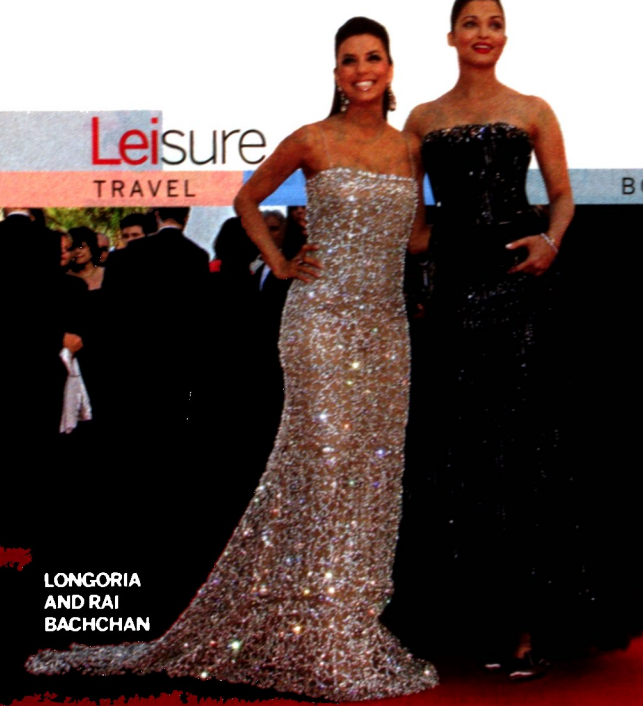




LONGORIA
AND RAI
BACHCHAN

BIG, BAD, UGLY

The number one rule on the Cannes Film Festival red carpet. Don't take along an accessory that will outshine you. Posing beside a slim, petite **Eva Longoria** did **Aishwarya Rai Bachchan** no good. Not only was Eva bobbing at Ash's shoulders but Ash's beehive hairstyle gave her volume she didn't really need. Also present, **Mallika Sherawat** (right) lived up to her attention-grabbing gimmicks, by posing with a python. It was enough to make hisstory.



GETTY IMAGES

Tragic Relief

Raveena Tandon is 'seriously' returning from exile. In a Bengali film directed by National Award-winner Raja Sen, she carries on the research of her dead scientist husband; in *Agni*, she is a rural woman fighting oppressive traditions; and in *Gulab Gang*, she is a gang leader fighting the Thakurs of Uttar Pradesh. Whatever happened to the former glamour girl of Bollywood? "I would love to do a comedy but the ones offered to me are all rubbish," she says. Try loosening up a little maybe.

PHOTOGRAPH BY [unreadable]



"Sex itself is a taboo word"

Actor Khushbu Sundar has come a long way, from courting controversies over her comments on sex to now plunging into politics

Q. Who do you think would make a better actor than a politician?

A. Lalu Prasad Yadav and Mayawati.

Q. The DMK? Because it is the ruling party?

A. Definitely not. Only the DMK gives space to grow and understands what I want to say.

Q. Will your views on sex be a help or hindrance during your political career?

A. It's been four-and-a-half years. Sex itself is a taboo word and we can leave it far behind.

GOING PLACES

Noureen DeWulf, 26, was last seen in the JLo-starrer, *The Back-up Plan*. Thanks to her Urdu and Gujarati skills, the US-based Indian will now act in *Taqwacores*, based on a novel on the Islamic punk rock scene. She's keen on trying her luck in Hindi films too. Why not? If Barbara Mori can.

AP



"Pani Puri
Par sehat adhuri!"

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